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SESSION 3 OF 6 · 3 HOURS

API Fundamentals for Non-Engineers

From prompt to a working integration

MSc in AI and Digital Strategy Management
Advanced Prompting & API Integration



Session roadmap



Time	Block	Format
0:00	Welcome back and access check	Plenary
0:15	What is an API?	Briefing + demo
0:45	Reading API documentation	Guided reading
1:10	Workshop 1: your first API call	Pairs
1:40	Break (10 min)	—
1:50	Connecting AI to an external service	Briefing + code reading
2:15	Workshop 2: build a minimal integration	Individual, peer help
2:45	Safe habits, deliverable, Session 4 preview	Plenary

What is an API?

A waiter between your tool and someone else's service: you order from the menu, the kitchen stays hidden.

Request

What you ask for: an address (URL), a method and parameters

Response

What comes back: data, usually JSON, plus a status code

Authentication

Proof you may ask: an API key, kept secret

Errors

Codes say what went wrong: 401 key, 404 not found, 429 too many requests

Reading API documentation

Look for	Why it matters	Example: public weather API
Endpoint	The address you call	api.open-meteo.com/v1/forecast
Parameters	What you can ask for	latitude, longitude, current
Authentication	Whether a key is needed	Check the terms of use
Example response	The shape of the data	JSON with a current block
Limits	How often you may call	Fair-use limits

AI plus API: two patterns

API → AI

Fetch data from a service, then ask the AI to use it.

Example: get today's forecast, then draft a customer notice

AI → API

The AI produces structured output that calls a service.

Example: AI extracts the city from an email, the API returns its weather

Your Session 2 chain steps are the AI parts. The API call is one more step.

Reading the code (read-only)

```
client = anthropic.Anthropic(api_key=KEY)
reply = client.messages.create(
    model="claude-sonnet-5-5",
    max_tokens=300,
    messages=[{"role": "user", "content": PROMPT}],
)
print(reply.content[0].text)
```

KEY proves it is you; keep it secret

MODEL which AI answers

MESSAGES your prompt goes in here

RESPONSE the text comes back here

WORKSHOP 1 · 30 MIN · PAIRS

Make your first API call

1. Find the endpoint and parameters in the documentation
2. Send the request with your low-code tool
3. Read the response and find the one value you need
4. Change one parameter and send it again

Output: one successful call and one value extracted



WORKSHOP 2 · 40 MIN · INDIVIDUAL, PEER HELP

Build a minimal integration

1. Pick one step of your chain that needs outside data
2. Connect it to a public API in your tool
3. Add the AI step with your Session 2 prompt
4. Run it end to end on one real input

Output: a working minimal integration



If it fails

- Is the key present?
- Is a parameter misspelt?
- What does the status code say?
- Ask a neighbour

Safe habits and next steps

Keep keys secret

Never paste a key into a chat, a slide or a shared document

Mind the data

No personal or confidential data in test calls

Watch the cost

Know your usage limits before you run loops

DELIVERABLE

A working minimal API integration

Email a screenshot of the working run plus 3 lines on what it does to fabien.gueret-jullien@bsb-education.com. Subject: [Session 3] Surname – Integration

SESSION 4

Designing a multi-step AI-to-API workflow

Chain several calls, handle errors and design for reliability.